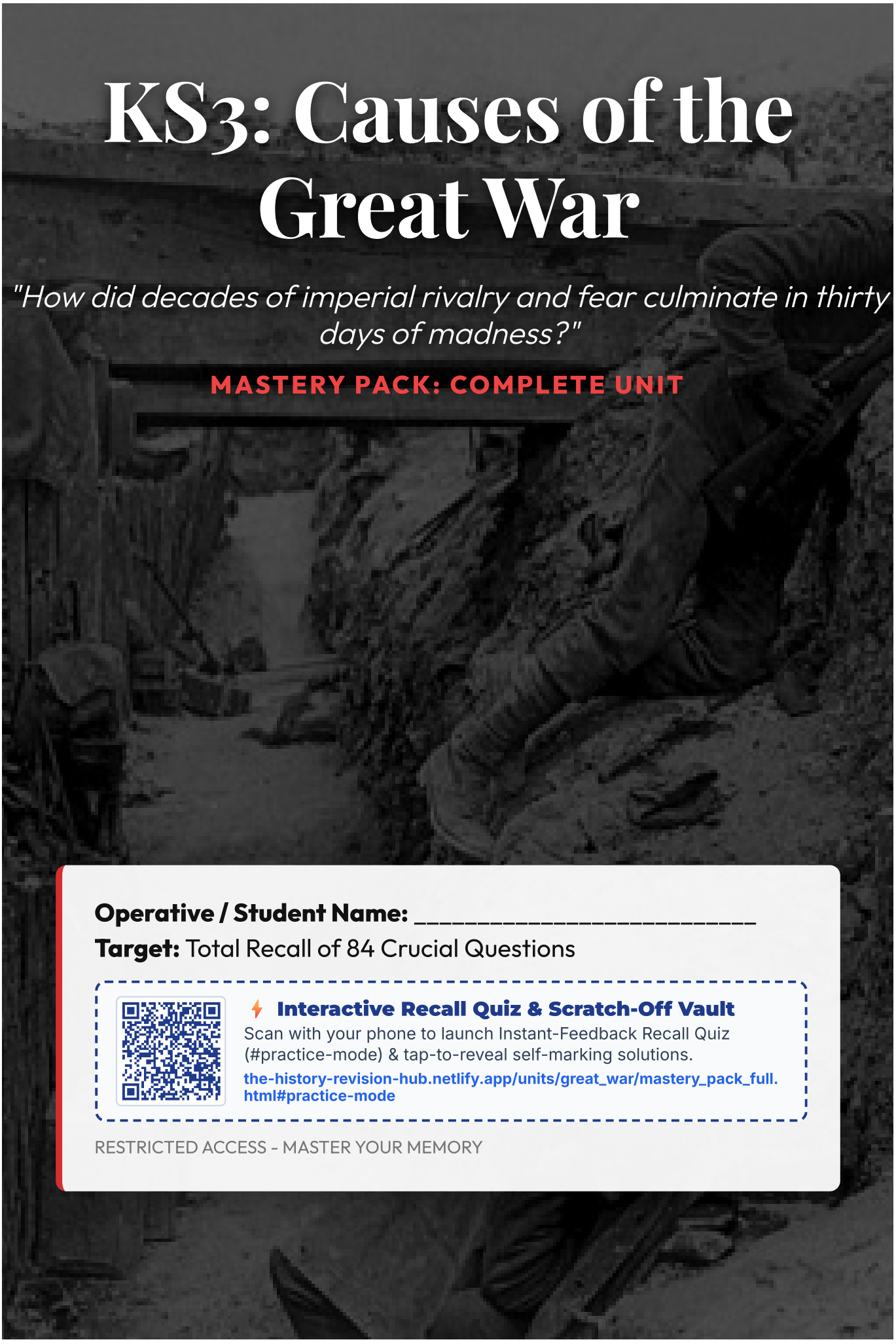


KS3: Causes of the Great War

"How did decades of imperial rivalry and fear culminate in thirty days of madness?"

MASTERY PACK: COMPLETE UNIT

Operative / Student Name: _____

Target: Total Recall of 84 Crucial Questions

Interactive Recall Quiz & Scratch-Off Vault

Scan with your phone to launch Instant-Feedback Recall Quiz (#practice-mode) & tap-to-reveal self-marking solutions.

the-history-revision-hub.netlify.app/units/great_war/mastery_pack_full.html#practice-mode

RESTRICTED ACCESS - MASTER YOUR MEMORY

How to Hack Your Memory

(Rules of Engagement)

1. Never Just Read

Reading the answers feels like learning, but it's an illusion. You must force your brain to struggle to find the answer. The struggle is what builds memory pathways.

2. Cover, Recall, Check

Cover the answer sheet. Write your answer down in the notes section (or say it out loud). Only then are you allowed to check 'The Vault'.

3. Track Your Threat Level

Use the R-A-G (Red, Amber, Green) checkboxes next to every question after you attempt it.

- 🟩 **Green:** I nailed it instantly.
- 🟨 **Amber:** I got it, but I had to think hard.
- 🟥 **Red:** My mind went blank. (Revisit these tomorrow).

4. The Interrogation (Homework Protocol)

True mastery requires testing under pressure. Hand 'The Vault' (answers) to your parent or guardian. They will test you on 20 random questions. They hold the score; they hold the signature.

5. The 3-Star Parent Effort Rubric

When authenticating your spaced retrieval practice on the final Mastery Tracker, your parent or guardian will evaluate your effort using the following criteria:

- ⭐ ⭐ ⭐ **3 Stars (Full Mastery):** Completed under strict exam conditions without glancing at notes or the Knowledge Vault. Total independent recall.
- ⭐ ⭐ **2 Stars (Consolidating):** Required 1–2 hints from the Knowledge Vault, but demonstrated sound foundational understanding.
- ⭐ **1 Star (Needs Intervention):** Rushed, mind went blank, or completed with notes open. Target facts must be hunted down and re-tested tomorrow.

How was the German Empire created in 1871?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
1	How many independent states existed in Central Europe before 1871?	☐	☐	☐	
2	Which state was the most powerful among the German states before 1871?	☐	☐	☐	
3	Who became the Prime Minister of Prussia in 1862?	☐	☐	☐	
4	What was Bismarck's famous phrase for how Germany would be unified?	☐	☐	☐	
5	What did 'blood and iron' mean in Bismarck's approach?	☐	☐	☐	
6	Which three countries did Prussia defeat to unify Germany?	☐	☐	☐	
7	In what year did the Franco-Prussian War begin?	☐	☐	☐	
8	Where was the King of Prussia proclaimed the first German Emperor?	☐	☐	☐	
9	When was the German Empire officially created?	☐	☐	☐	
10	Which valuable French territory did Germany seize in 1871?	☐	☐	☐	
11	What was the economic union created by Prussia in 1834 called?	☐	☐	☐	
12	Which major German-speaking power was deliberately excluded from the Zollverein?	☐	☐	☐	
13	What was the German term for the new German Empire?	☐	☐	☐	
14	How long did it take the Prussian army to crush Austria in 1866?	☐	☐	☐	
15	Who was the first Emperor (Kaiser) of the newly unified Germany?	☐	☐	☐	
16	Why did Bismarck provoke a war with France in 1870?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
17	Which French Emperor was captured by the Prussian military?	☐	☐	☐	
18	What natural resources was Alsace-Lorraine rich in?	☐	☐	☐	
19	What long-term effect did the taking of Alsace-Lorraine have?	☐	☐	☐	
20	Why was the unification of Germany a shock to the balance of power in Europe?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

Score: _____ / 20

Parent/Guardian Authentication (Signature): _____

Date: _____

How did the Franco-Prussian War create a lasting legacy of hatred?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
21	Who was the Chancellor of Prussia that orchestrated the Franco-Prussian War?	☐	☐	☐	
22	Which telegram did Bismarck edit to provoke France into war?	☐	☐	☐	
23	In what year did the Franco-Prussian War break out?	☐	☐	☐	
24	Which two provinces were taken from France in the peace settlement?	☐	☐	☐	
25	Where was the German Empire proclaimed in 1871, humiliating the French?	☐	☐	☐	
26	What was the size of the war indemnity France was forced to pay?	☐	☐	☐	
27	Who became the new German Emperor in 1888 and dismissed Bismarck?	☐	☐	☐	
28	What secret treaty did Bismarck sign with Russia that Wilhelm II allowed to expire?	☐	☐	☐	
29	Which country allied with Russia in 1894 after Bismarck's dismissal?	☐	☐	☐	
30	What was Germany's greatest fear that drove its military planning?	☐	☐	☐	
31	What was the name of the German military plan created to defeat France quickly?	☐	☐	☐	
32	Which French leader was captured at the Battle of Sedan?	☐	☐	☐	
33	What was the primary goal of Bismarck in defeating France?	☐	☐	☐	
34	Which French territory was annexed by Germany, creating lasting resentment?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
35	Who was the Prussian King that was crowned German Emperor?	☐	☐	☐	
36	What event did Bismarck use to trick France into declaring war?	☐	☐	☐	
37	What happened to Napoleon III at the Battle of Sedan?	☐	☐	☐	
38	What treaty formally ended the Franco-Prussian War?	☐	☐	☐	
39	Why did Bismarck fear a French alliance with Russia?	☐	☐	☐	
40	Where exactly was the new German Empire proclaimed?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

Score: _____ / 20

Parent/Guardian Authentication (Signature): _____

Date: _____

To what extent did the 'Scramble for Africa' increase tension in Europe?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
41	What term describes the rapid colonization of Africa by European powers in the late 19th century?	☐	☐	☐	
42	Which German leader famously stated that Germany wanted its 'place in the sun'?	☐	☐	☐	
43	In which year did the First Moroccan Crisis occur?	☐	☐	☐	
44	What was the purpose of the 1884 Berlin Conference?	☐	☐	☐	
45	Which European power controlled the largest empire in Africa by 1914?	☐	☐	☐	
46	Why did Kaiser Wilhelm II demand a 'place in the sun'?	☐	☐	☐	
47	What happened during the First Moroccan Crisis (1905)?	☐	☐	☐	
48	What was the main result of the Algeciras Conference (1906)?	☐	☐	☐	
49	What sparked the Second Moroccan Crisis (Agadir Crisis) in 1911?	☐	☐	☐	
50	How did the Agadir Crisis end?	☐	☐	☐	
51	What effect did the Moroccan Crises have on Anglo-French relations?	☐	☐	☐	
52	What revolutionary British battleship was launched in 1906?	☐	☐	☐	
53	Which German Admiral was in charge of expanding the German Navy?	☐	☐	☐	
54	What policy dictated that the British Royal Navy must be as large as the next two largest navies combined?	☐	☐	☐	
55	Why was the HMS Dreadnought completely revolutionary?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
56	What was the consequence of the Dreadnought's launch?	☐	☐	☐	
57	What was the German 'Risk Theory' proposed by Admiral Tirpitz?	☐	☐	☐	
58	What slogan did the British public chant in 1909 to demand more ships?	☐	☐	☐	
59	Why did Britain feel so threatened by the German naval expansion?	☐	☐	☐	
60	What laws were passed in Germany to fund their massive naval buildup?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

Score: _____ / 20

Parent/Guardian Authentication (Signature): _____

Date: _____

Why did a battleship building contest destroy Anglo-German relations?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
61	By 1914, who had won the naval race?	☐	☐	☐	
62	How did the naval race affect British foreign policy?	☐	☐	☐	
63	Which three countries formed the Triple Entente in 1907?	☐	☐	☐	
64	Which country left the Triple Alliance and joined the Entente in 1915?	☐	☐	☐	
65	What was Britain's traditional foreign policy before forming alliances?	☐	☐	☐	
66	Which three countries made up the Triple Alliance of 1882?	☐	☐	☐	
67	Which three countries formed the Triple Entente by 1907?	☐	☐	☐	
68	What was a major flaw of the alliance system?	☐	☐	☐	
69	Why did Russia ally with France in 1894?	☐	☐	☐	
70	What was the 'Entente Cordiale' signed in 1904?	☐	☐	☐	
71	Why did Britain finally decide to form alliances?	☐	☐	☐	
72	What does 'Weltpolitik' mean?	☐	☐	☐	
73	Which nation in the Triple Alliance was seen as the 'weak link'?	☐	☐	☐	
74	Who assassinated Archduke Franz Ferdinand?	☐	☐	☐	
75	What was the name of the Serbian nationalist group responsible for the assassination?	☐	☐	☐	
76	On what exact date was the Archduke assassinated?	☐	☐	☐	

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
77	Which empire had annexed Bosnia in 1908, angering Serbian nationalists?	☐	☐	☐	
78	Who was the heir to the Austro-Hungarian throne that visited Sarajevo?	☐	☐	☐	
79	What terrorist group supplied the assassins with weapons?	☐	☐	☐	
80	What was the first, failed assassination attempt on the Archduke that morning?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

Score: _____ / 20

Parent/Guardian Authentication (Signature): _____

Date: _____

Why did a single assassination in Sarajevo ignite a World War?

Q#	The Target Question	R	A	G	Notes / My Answer
81	Why was Gavrilo Princip standing outside Schiller's Delicatessen when the Archduke's car stopped?	☐	☐	☐	
82	What was the 'Blank Cheque'?	☐	☐	☐	
83	What happened on July 23, 1914?	☐	☐	☐	
84	Why did Britain declare war on Germany on August 4, 1914?	☐	☐	☐	

MISSION DEBRIEF

Score: _____ / 20

Parent/Guardian Authentication (Signature): _____

Date: _____

THE VAULT

Restricted Access: Answer Keys

How was the German Empire created in 1871?

1. 39
2. Prussia
3. Otto von Bismarck
4. Blood and iron
5. Warfare and military strength
6. Denmark, Austria, France
7. 1870
8. Palace of Versailles
9. 18 January 1871
10. Alsace-Lorraine
11. Zollverein
12. Austria
13. Kaiserreich
14. Seven weeks
15. Wilhelm I
16. To unite the southern German states with the north
17. Napoleon III
18. Coal and iron
19. It created long-term rivalry and hatred between France and Germany
20. A massive, powerful, militaristic state suddenly appeared in the center of Europe

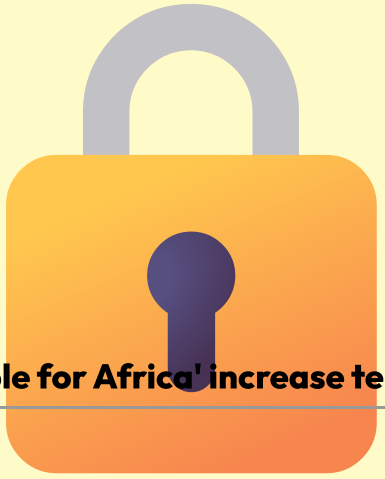


How did the Franco-Prussian War create a lasting legacy of hatred?

21. Otto von Bismarck
22. Ems Telegram
23. 1870
24. Alsace and Lorraine
25. Palace of Versailles
26. 5 billion francs
27. Kaiser Wilhelm II
28. Reinsurance Treaty

How did the Franco-Prussian War create a lasting legacy of hatred?

29. France
30. A two-front war
31. Schlieffen Plan
32. Napoleon III
33. To unify the southern German states with the north
34. Alsace-Lorraine
35. Wilhelm I
36. Editing the Ems Telegram
37. He was captured along with his army
38. Treaty of Frankfurt
39. It would force Germany into a two-front war
40. The Hall of Mirrors at Versailles



To what extent did the 'Scramble for Africa' increase tension in Europe?

41. The Scramble for Africa
42. Kaiser Wilhelm II
43. 1905
44. To regulate European colonization and trade in Africa
45. Britain
46. He wanted Germany to have a global empire like Britain and France
47. The Kaiser visited Tangier and declared support for Moroccan independence
48. Germany was humiliated and France was given control of Moroccan police
49. Germany sent the gunboat Panther to the port of Agadir
50. Germany backed down after being given a small strip of the Congo
51. It pushed Britain and France closer together in a strong alliance
52. HMS Dreadnought
53. Admiral von Tirpitz
54. Two-Power Standard
55. It was faster, heavier armored, and had all 'big-guns'
56. It made all older battleships instantly obsolete, resetting the naval race

To what extent did the 'Scramble for Africa' increase tension in Europe?

57. Building a navy large enough that Britain wouldn't risk fighting it
58. 'We want eight and we won't wait!'
59. Britain is an island and relied entirely on its navy for survival and trade
60. The Naval Laws of 1898 and 1900

Why did a battleship building contest destroy Anglo-German relations?

61. Britain, with 29 dreadnoughts to Germany's 17
62. It forced Britain out of 'Splendid Isolation' and into an alliance with France and Russia
63. Britain, France, Russia
64. Italy
65. Splendid Isolation
66. Germany, Austria-Hungary, Italy
67. Britain, France, Russia
68. A small dispute between two nations could drag all major powers into war
69. Because Kaiser Wilhelm II allowed the Reinsurance Treaty with Russia to lapse
70. A friendly agreement between Britain and France, settling colonial disputes
71. They felt threatened by Germany's growing navy and aggressive Weltpolitik
72. World policy (Germany's desire for a global empire)
73. Italy
74. Gavrilo Princip
75. The Black Hand
76. 28 June 1914
77. Austria-Hungary
78. Archduke Franz Ferdinand
79. The Black Hand
80. A bomb was thrown at his car but bounced off

Why did a single assassination in Sarajevo ignite a World War?

81. By total coincidence, the driver took a wrong turn and stalled the car right in front of him
82. Germany's promise of unconditional support to Austria-Hungary against Serbia
83. Austria-Hungary sent an impossibly harsh ultimatum to Serbia
84. Germany invaded neutral Belgium, violating the 1839 Treaty of London

Mastery Tracker

Track your total recall score across all 84 questions.

Attempt	Date	Score (/84)	Parent Validation Stamp	Target for Next Time
1			**PARENT VALIDATION STAMP** **Effort:** ⭐ ⭐ ⭐ (Circle 1–3) Date: _____ Signature: _____	
2			**PARENT VALIDATION STAMP** **Effort:** ⭐ ⭐ ⭐ (Circle 1–3) Date: _____ Signature: _____	
3			**PARENT VALIDATION STAMP** **Effort:** ⭐ ⭐ ⭐ (Circle 1–3) Date: _____ Signature: _____	

Operative Reflection

1. My ultimate strength in this unit is...

2. The three specific facts I need to hunt down and memorize tonight are...

3. Key targets and action steps for the next retrieval attempt: